

You are invited to

A Knight of Murder

Hear ye! Hear ye!

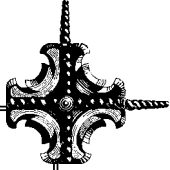
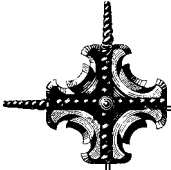
All ye Kings and Queens,
Knights and Nobles!

A tournament celebration is planned to honor the noble marriage of Baron Bartholomew to Lady Diana of Dunnsberry in the manor of Fernwood. As a resident of the manor, you are not only invited to be there, but your attendance is required by the request of your lord.

Whether it is to see a joust between two knights or partake in the ale and entertainment, your business is but your own... that is until you find yourself in the middle of a murder.

With only one night to find the guilty, you will soon figure out that there is a lot more at stake, for murder in the manor is punishable by death. Whether you are guilty or not, there will be others trying to finger you as the culprit as you try to find the real murderer, and only you can defend your innocence. Who do you trust? Who will betray you before the night is through? Everyone is a suspect and no one is safe in this mystery of medieval madness.

Be careful in attending. Your life will depend not only on your innocence, but your ability to defend it.



Join us for an evening of mystery & mayhem in the Middle Ages

Rules in the Manor of Fernwood

Whether this is your first murder mystery experience or your fortieth, each murder mystery experience is different and has different rules pertaining. Here are some tips to make sure this evening is an unforgettable experience.

Read Your Character Sheet—This contains your identity and all the information you will need to play your part.

Don't Reveal Everything About Your Character—While there are many things that everyone needs to know about you, there are some things that should remain secret. Use your discretion to not give too much away-- you may find out at the party that you are the killer indeed!

Dress The Part— It's a proven fact that the more into character you are the easier it will be for you to truly enjoy all the aspects of the night. It also adds to the excitement, the photo opps, and your chance to be voted best dressed. Please see the "party extras" section at www.nightofmystery.com for ideas on costuming.

Review the Announcements—Included in this invite will be manor announcements. Review this page, it includes background information (such as the other characters attending), which may come in useful the night of the party.

Use Your Money Creatively—Upon arrival, you will receive gold coins to spend any way you choose. Bribery and blackmail are two of the most common uses we found (and highly encouraged). The wealthiest player at the end of the night will also receive an award for their ability to turn a profit.

Hear Ye! Hear Ye!

It is by decree of the lord and lady of Fernwood that the people of the manor are invited and ordered to attend the noble marriage of their son, **Baron Bartholomew**, to **Lady Diana of Dunnsberry**. The wedding is to take place on **December Second**, the one year anniversary of their meeting. A tournament of jousting pleasure is to follow to commemorate this momentous occasion in which the victorious knight will be awarded many riches plus the lady of his choice as escort for the celebration that night. Those expected to be in attendance are as follows:

King Kyle: The ruler of this prosperous kingdom. He is well liked by everyone. It's hard to have many enemies when the punishment of betrayal is death!

Queen Genevieve: Wife of King Kyle. She rules equally alongside her king.

Sheriff: The king's official in Fernwood. He is in charge of collecting the taxes in the manor, which have been dwindling even though prosperity seems to be at its highest.

Lord Taylor: He runs the manor happily with Lady Gwendolyn. He is throwing the tournament in celebration of his only son's marriage to the noble woman of his choosing.

Lady Gwendolyn: Runs the manor lands with her husband Lord Taylor. She is delighted for the tournament, it means prosperity and happiness & the marriage of her only son to another noble.

Baron Bartholomew: The son of Lord Taylor and Lady Gwendolyn. The tournament is planned in honor of his marriage to another noble on the one year anniversary of their meeting. His only regret is that he must marry for wealth and not for love.

Lady Diana of Dunnsberry: Noble woman of Dunnsberry, she arrived in Fernwood in search of a husband that she found, but at the cost of breaking up one true love.

Maid Monica: She is the one who always caught the baron's eye (and heart). Since the baron's engagement

has been set with another woman, some say Monica has turned rather ruthless.

Maid Marilyn: Lady Gwendolyn's lady-in-waiting. Maid Marilyn is like a daughter to the lady and knows her lady will do anything for her happiness.

Sir Rufus: Sir Rufus is a relatively new knight to the manor and does not have as favorable of a reputation as Sir Cameron. He is hoping to increase his popularity with a victory over Sir Cameron in the tournament.

Sir Cameron: A gallant knight who is entertaining and fighting for his honor in the manor tournament. Word is that if he wins, he will be asking for the favor of Maid Marilyn.

Gallant Gary: Squire to Sir Cameron. He will do anything for his knight, Sir Cameron. Gary must prove valor, loyalty and honor in order to gain knighthood.

Charlamagne: As chambermaid, she is the lowest of the servants to live in the castle. Charlamagne knows the castle in and out and has seen a lot. Her access to all of the castle may also be what gets her into trouble.

Poor Pearl: A peasant woman whose small earnings have grown even smaller since the sheriff has been enforcing the laws in the manor.

William the Watchman: As the manor watchman, he is the security for the lord and his manor lands. He is sure to be the enforcer if anyone gets out of hand at the tournament.

Anyone not attending the wedding and celebration will be considered a traitor to the lord and lady and will be banished from the manor.

Laws of the Land

As set forth by King Kyle on how his kingdom is to be ruled

I. Betrayal of the king or queen is punishable by death!!!

II. The lord's word is law in his manor

- a. The only person that can overrule a lord is the king.
- b. A manor consists of a castle, church and the surrounding lands granted to the lord by the king or queen.

III. Everyone that makes earnings, must tithe a percentage of their earnings to the king

- a. Percentages are set by the king or queen .
- b. Tithes (taxes) are collected by the sheriff in compliance with the wishes of the king or queen.

IV. The manor is to be run with a system as follows:

- a. Lords & Ladies—granted land from the king and may run the manor as they see fit. They award land to the vassals and knights in exchange for protection from invaders. Among their duties are arranging marriages within their manor and administering justice.
- b. Vassals & Knights—are awarded land from the nobles of the manor. They are free to farm the land or pay peasants to do so. They may also have serfs that live on and farm their land.
- c. Peasants—often live in huts outside the castle walls and work on land owned by vassals or knights for a percentage of the profits. They still have their freedom, but own no land.
- d. Serfs—they are slaves to the lord for life. They farm the land for food and shelter, they are not allowed to have earthly possessions and in order to gain any freedom, they must escape and live one year plus one day in another manor. They are never required to fight, but are guaranteed protection from invaders. They need permission to marry.

V. Tournaments are to be a time of great celebration

- a. To be held to honor such events as coronation, a noble marriage or to boost the economy of a manor.
- b. The victorious knight may request the favor of any lady at the celebration. She will then be his escort for the evening.

Sheriff

You are the Sheriff of Fernwood. You were appointed by the king to collect taxes and administer the laws in the manor of Fernwood. You started your duties as a loving and loyal servant, but as you saw the manor prosper and your wages remain the same, you got greedy and started to take a bigger share of the tax money. Then you got even greedier and increased the taxes from 10% to 15% for the vassals and the peasants (serfs are so lowly they don't even have earnings on which to pay taxes). Many of the peasants fought you on this and you have enlisted the services of Sir Rufus, a corrupt knight, to help you enforce this new "law" that you established. You have assured the families that if they do not pay up, their lives will suffer at the hands of Sir Rufus. Since then, having a knight behind you to insure enforcement has helped speed up the tax collection process.

Even though you have increased the taxes, the king has noticed a drop in the riches he is receiving. This is because you have been pocketing all of the profits...and then some. You blame the missing money on the profitability (or lack of it) of the manor. You claim that Lord Taylor is not doing his job and thus the people of the manor have less earnings to give to the king. You are hoping that King Kyle will see that he has chosen a poor leader and award you rule of the manor instead. In order to make this happen, though, you need to make sure that the king and queen do not find out that you are behind the stolen money or they will never award the manor to someone who betrayed them. You must also insure King Kyle and Queen Genevieve that Lord Taylor is not fit to run a peaceful and profitable manor. You intend to use the tournament to do so.

You are looking forward to the tournament celebration. The tournament celebration will be the perfect time for you to prove to the king or queen that the lord and lady are unfit rulers. You hope that the night of the celebration will be the night where you will gain nobility.

Acting and Dressing Your Part: You are the sheriff and thus you have power in the community. You must come dressed in your medieval best. Due to your recent acquisition of riches from the poor, you have yourself outfitted in gold and jewels. Act arrogant and pompous, so that people of lower stature will respect you. *For ideas on costumes and accessories, please see the "Party Extras" section at www.nightofmystery.com*